

Your company wants to use AI. Where should it start?

An FDE works inside the business to find the right first problem, then turns it into a system people use and results can prove.



AI can now do the work

We used to complete every step manually.

Agents can now read documents, retrieve data, use tools, and complete a sequence of tasks. When review is required, they hand the decision back to a person.

HOW THE OPERATING MODEL CHANGES

- Agents take on repetitive execution.
 - People remain responsible for goals, judgment, and review.
 - One manager can direct several agents.
 - Companies can turn working knowledge into reusable workflows and Skills.
 - In 2025, Microsoft introduced the idea of the Agent Boss: an employee who builds, delegates to, and manages agents.
 - OpenAI defines agents as systems that can complete workflows on a user's behalf, rather than simply answer questions.
 - Google describes enterprise agents as systems that connect models with company data, tools, memory, orchestration, and runtime infrastructure.
 - Anthropic's research suggests that people tend to decide what should be done, while agents make more of the execution decisions about how to do it.
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Operating efficiency will diverge with how AI-native a company becomes.

The numbers are already moving

81%

Microsoft’s 2025 Work Trend Index surveyed 31,000 workers across 31 countries. 81% of surveyed leaders expected agents to enter their company’s AI strategy within 12–18 months.

Microsoft · 2025

1M+

In 2025, OpenAI reported more than one million business customers.

OpenAI · 2025

108x

Since February, weekly active Codex users grew 108x in legal, 41x in sales, 41x in recruiting, and 26x in marketing.

OpenAI · 2026

PUBLIC EXAMPLES ALREADY IN PRODUCTION

Cisco:

OpenAI reports that Codex reduced code review time by 50% and shortened some projects from weeks to days.

Carlyle:

Its multi-agent due diligence framework reportedly cut development time by more than 50% and improved agent accuracy by 30%.

TELUS:

A Google Cloud customer story reports \$53.9 million in annual savings, 87% faster issue resolution, and 30% of calls resolved proactively with AI.

Lowe’s:

OpenAI reports that Lowe’s provides AI-powered project guidance to associates across more than 1,700 stores.

Leaders want higher efficiency, but do not know where to begin

MANY COMPANIES HAVE ALREADY TRIED AI

- Employees have subscriptions but use them only occasionally.
- A demo looked good, but nobody used it after launch.
- Other companies' cases do not fit the way this company works.
- Every department has ideas, but nobody can set priorities.
- Information is scattered across chat, spreadsheets, PDFs, drives, and personal computers.
- Leaders worry about security and do not know how much authority an agent should have.

AI transformation crosses four boundaries

The outcome leadership wants

How frontline work actually happens

Where the data and systems live

How the solution gets built

Leave out one layer and the project often stalls.

WHY INTERNAL PROJECTS STALL

Listen only to leadership

The ambition is broad, but the first practical job remains unclear.

Listen only to frontline teams

You collect scattered requests but cannot identify the best investment.

Start with a software vendor

The vendor needs clear requirements—the thing the company still lacks.

Buy a standard product

Deployment is fast, but the workflow may not fit.

Build a large platform first

Time and money are committed before business value is tested.

A company needs someone who can connect business, product, and technology. That is the FDE's role.

An FDE starts with ambiguity and stays until results can be tested

A Forward Deployed Engineer does more than write code at a customer site.

The work starts by observing the business: why leadership wants AI, what employees do each day, where the data lives, and where time, errors, or slow response hurt the company.

Once the problem is clear, the FDE chooses how to solve it:

- Use an existing product when it already solves the problem.

- Build a Skill when a Skill is enough.

- Integrate with existing systems when the workflow crosses tools.

- Create a database or knowledge base when the data must be organized first.

- Design the division of work between people and agents when the workflow is suitable.

From one small tool to a company-wide AI upgrade

One specific problem

- Company-specific Skills
- Document, spreadsheet, and image processing
- Quotation, entry, reconciliation, and reporting automation
- Small custom SaaS

Best when the problem is clear and results are needed quickly.

One business workflow

- Interviews and workflow mapping
- Role-specific agents
- ERP, CRM, collaboration, and messaging integrations
- Exception handling and human approval
- Progress, result, and activity records

Best when work crosses people and systems through manual handoffs.

A data foundation

- Operational databases
- Enterprise knowledge bases
- Data cleanup and consistent naming
- Permissions and usage boundaries
- Trusted data for agents

Best when information is hard to find, share, or trust.

A company-wide upgrade

- Identify work suitable for AI across departments
- Redesign how people and agents divide the work
- Set permissions, approvals, and accountability
- Define the pilot sequence and expansion plan
- Train the company's own Agent Bosses

Best when leadership wants one coordinated program.

Assess first.

Build only if it is worth building.

1. Clarify why the company wants AI: save time, reduce errors, increase revenue, or change how the company works.

2. Observe the spreadsheets, files, messages, and business systems employees really use—including exceptions outside the official process.

3. Rank opportunities by value, difficulty, data readiness, risk, and time to validation. Not every problem needs AI.

4. Choose one job. Agree on the owner, data, scope, and result metric before building a usable version.

5. After real users have tried it, decide whether to improve it, expand it, or stop.

Not a demo.

A working test with evidence.

Depending on the agreed scope, a pilot may include:

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| — A map of the current workflow | — The problem and pilot boundary |
| — A working prototype or system | — The data and permissions used |
| — Responsibilities for people and agents | — Human approval points |
| — A before-and-after comparison method | — A recommendation to continue, adjust, or stop |

BEFORE WORK BEGINS, WE AGREE ON

- | | |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| — Who owns the outcome | — What completion means |
| — What is outside this pilot | — How the result will be judged |

Show what changed in the business, not only what the system looks like

FDE PROJECT WORK | Turning commerce and manufacturing workflows into working systems.

GLOBAL INDUSTRIAL MANUFACTURERS



The brands above come from public company materials for industry reference; they do not imply an FDE client or partner relationship. Company names are omitted from the cases below.

ANONYMOUS CASE 1 | CROSS-BORDER E-COMMERCE

Before

Operators assembled product details from supplier spreadsheets, chat messages, and image folders, then translated, normalized, and entered each listing across marketplaces.

What we delivered

A product-data hub and listing workflow. Agents organize, translate, and check rules; operators handle exceptions and approve publication.

What we found

The bottleneck was incomplete attributes, conflicting source files, and repeated manual checks against marketplace rules—not copywriting alone.

What changed

- Product data: scattered files → one workflow
- Manual work: copy each field → review exceptions
- Rework: after publishing → checks before release
- Business impact: a steadier listing cadence

ANONYMOUS CASE 2 | FURNITURE MANUFACTURING

Orders arrived through chat, spreadsheets, and drawings. We structured dimensions, fabrics, hardware, and processes; connected orders, BOMs, and work orders; and flagged missing or conflicting data before production.

A working agent still needs someone who knows how to lead it

FDE delivery builds the company's AI upgrade.

After launch, managers and employees need to know how to:

- Give agents clear goals and completion criteria

- Decide which work can be delegated

- Review the process and the result

We call this training **Agent Boss**.

It is not a prompt-writing class or a tour of AI tools. It teaches people how to lead work carried out by both humans and agents.

- Handle exceptions, request changes, or stop a task

- Manage data, tools, and permissions

- Turn good practices into shared Skills

- Remain accountable for the business outcome

AgentBoss School is open source

**github.com/ElliottYip/agentboss-school
MIT · v0.7.1**

Find the right first step

During the event, we are offering a complimentary enterprise AI assessment.

YOU WILL RECEIVE

- One to three areas worth examining first
- An initial judgment on whether AI fits the work
- The data, systems, and people required
- A recommendation: buy software, build a Skill, create custom SaaS, organize data, or redesign the workflow
- An honest view on whether a pilot is worthwhile

WE MAY ALSO TELL YOU

- The problem does not need AI
- The data is not ready
- Fix the workflow before building
- An existing product is better value

The assessment does not include a complete plan and does not require access to unauthorized sensitive data.

Which part of your business should AI improve first?

10 companies per day
20 over the two-day
event

FEISHU QR CODE

ADD ME ON FEISHU AND SEND:

1. Your company and industry

2. The one area you most want to improve

3. How the work is done today

4. Who owns that part of the business

5. Your preferred time to talk

ADD ME ON FEISHU · SEND TO RESERVE

Start with one problem you can understand, complete, and measure.